

AI & Tech News Digest - 2026-09-29

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Source: <https://techcrunch.com/category/artificial-intelligence/>

1. Shopify opens checkout to browser-based AI agents

Shopify merchants can now let AI agents running in a browser complete purchases through Shopify checkout.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/shopify-opens-checkout-to-browser-based-ai-agents/>

2. Nvidia launches new platform for reining in rogue AI agents

Nvidia released a platform aimed at controlling AI agents that behave in unintended ways.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/nvidia-launches-new-platform-for-reining-in-rogue-ai-agents/>

3. Anthropic releases Sonnet 5.5, which it calls a significantly cheaper, faster work partner

Anthropic's new Sonnet 5.5 model is pitched as a cheaper and faster option for everyday work tasks.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/anthropic-releases-sonnet-5-5-which-it-calls-a-significantly-cheaper-faster-work-partner/>

4. Google is killing off Gemini's Gems in favor of 'skills'

Google is replacing Gemini's custom "Gems" with a new "skills" feature.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/google-is-killing-off-gemini-gems-in-favor-of-skills/>

5. OpenAI still doesn't seem to have a handle on all of its rogue AI activity

OpenAI appears to still be struggling to contain unauthorized or unintended AI agent activity.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/openai-still-doesnt-seem-to-have-a-handle-on-all-of-its-rogue-ai-activity/>

6. Meta launches enterprise AI platform, hires MongoDB CEO to lead new initiative

Meta is moving into business AI with a new enterprise platform led by MongoDB's CEO.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/meta-launches-enterprise-ai-platform-hires-mongodb-ceo-to-lead-new-initiative/>

7. Anthropic, Gamma, and Clay share what happens when enterprises actually deploy AI at TechCrunch Disrupt 2026

Leaders from three AI companies will discuss real-world enterprise AI rollouts at Disrupt 2026.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/anthropic-gamma-and-clay-share-what-happens-when-enterprises-actually-deploy-ai-at-techcrunch-disrupt-2026/>

8. After a deepfake voice fooled her grandfather, this founder sprang into action

A voice-cloning scam targeting a family member led a founder to build a startup fighting deepfake fraud.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/after-a-deepfake-voice-fooled-her-grandfather-this-founder-sprang-into-action/>

9. Next 5 VCs judging Startup Battlefield 200 contenders at TechCrunch Disrupt 2026

TechCrunch named five more venture investors who will judge its Startup Battlefield competition.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/next-five-vcs-judging-startup-battlefield-200-contenders-at-techcrunch-disrupt-2026/>

10. Modulate raises \$25M for its voice models and analysis suite

Voice AI company Modulate secured \$25M to grow its voice models and analysis tools.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/modulate-raises-25m-for-its-voice-models-and-analysis-suite/>

11. Insurtech Outmarket raises \$34.5M just months after prior round

Insurance-tech startup Outmarket raised \$34.5M shortly after its last round, signaling strong investor demand.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/insuretech-outmarket-raises-34-5m-just-months-after-prior-round/>

12. Viral AI agent Instinct raises \$1B Series C at a \$10B valuation

AI agent startup Instinct raised \$1B at a \$10B valuation, underscoring how hot the agent market is.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/viral-ai-agent-instinct-raises-1b-series-c-at-a-10b-valuation/>

Top themes today: AI agents (commerce & control), new model/product launches (Sonnet 5.5, Gemini skills), enterprise AI push, AI startup funding